PANELTEC PTY LTD

P O Box 148 Kings Meadows, TAS 7249

ABN: 12 128 689 412

SWMS-27

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	**Supervisor/Foreman**	**Date:**	
High Risk Construction Work:	**MOBILE CRANE - SAFE OPERATION**	**Project:**	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. *SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier* **Signature:** ______		**Location:**	

Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"

John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023	______	31/08/2025 – V12.0
Name	**Position**	☎	**Signature**	**Date**

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L *Likely*	M *Moderate*	U Unlikely
H (1) *(High level of harm)*	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) *(High)*	1	1	2
M (2) *(Medium level of harm)*	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) *(Medium)*	1	2	3
L (3) *(Low level of harm)*	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) *(Low)*	2	3	3

Level	Likelihood / Probability
Likely	Could happen frequently
Moderate	Could happen occasionally
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 **Eliminate the hazard**
Level 2 **Substitute the hazard with something safer.**
Level 3 **Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.**
Level 4 **Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.**
Level 5 **Use personal protective equipment**
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
Licensing requirements	Potential for personal injury and injuries to other persons.	**1**	1. The crane operator must hold the appropriate High-Risk Licence/certificate of competency to operate the mobile crane. 2. The person slinging the load or directing the operator must hold a High-Risk Licence/certificate of competency for Dogging or Rigging whichever is applicable. 3. Crane operators and doggers/riggers should make themselves familiar with the particular crane they are going to use on the day referring to the operator's manual. 4. Both the operator and the dogman should be familiar with the standard hand signals that are to be used. 5. UHF radios to be used where required.	Team Leader	**2**
Entry to Site	Unfamiliar work site potential for injury	**1**	1. All persons on site to attend the required site induction. 2. Access cards and sign on completed as required.	Team Leader	**2**
Traffic Management	Unauthorised vehicle and pedestrian traffic. Personal injury.	**1**	1. Signs and or barricades to be erected outside of Crane Operating area. 2. 'Crane In Operation' signs to be displayed. 3. Pedestrian and vehicle access still allowed outside of restricted area.	Team Leader	**2**
Personal Protective Equipment	To prevent injuries to the head, feet and body	**1**	1. Crane operators and persons working around cranes are to wear the appropriate PPE including but not limited to; Hard Hats, Fluro vests/Clothing, Riggers Gloves and Safety Boots.	Team Leader Operator	**2**
Equipment Pre-start checks	Potential for personal injury and injuries to other persons.	**1**	1. Prior to operating a crane, the operator must complete and document the daily pre-start checks using the company 'Daily Crane Operator Checks' form. 2. All faults must be recorded on the form and the Team Leader notified immediately if the fault is a safety issue.	Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
Planning/Site Inspection	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident.	**1**	1. The crane operator is to complete a 'safe lifting plan' which will incorporate all of the following considerations. 2. Inspect the work site prior to setting up the crane and document hazards and risk controls that will be put in place. 3. Discuss hazards and controls with site personnel. 4. Crane operations should be undertaken only when weather conditions are suitable, considering strong winds & heavy rain. 5. When loads have to be handled in the vicinity of persons, extreme care should be exercised, and adequate clearances allowed, and work area signed as required. 6. Crane drivers and dogmen should pay particular attention to possible dangers of persons working out of sight. 7. All persons should stand clear of the load being lifted.	Team Leader	**2**
	Contact or collision with other plant and structures	**1**	1. Contact or collision with other plant and structures may occur where sufficient clearances are not maintained between the mobile crane and other plant and structures, such as other cranes, buildings and overhead powerlines.	Team Leader Operator	**2**
	Structural failure could cause injury	**1**	1. Structural failure may include the failure of any crane component, such as the boom, jib, hydraulic rams or wire rope. A mobile crane may suffer structural failure if the crane has been overloaded in the structural area of its load chart. Structural failure may occur without warning.	Team Leader Operator	**2**
Set up Crane	Positioning cranes and deploying outriggers Personnel injury/Plant damage	**1**	1. Dogman will be needed to guide cranes into required radius and/ or lifting position. 2. Persons to keep clear of plant.	Team Leader All	**2**
	Unstable ground -crane could topple over causing death/injury to bystanders	**1**	1. Carry out a site inspection prior to lift day to verify suitable ground surface. 2. Outriggers should always be used for maximum stability. 3. All four outriggers should be positioned properly so the machine is perfectly level.	Team Leader Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
		1	4. The machine should be raised by means of the outriggers so that the weight is removed from the tyres. 5. The outrigger beams should be locked with lock pins. 6. Careful consideration should be given to the site selected for the mobile crane. It is important that the ground on which the crane sits is level, well compacted and stable enough to support the weight of the crane and its load without collapse or subsidence. 7. Rapid slewing could cause crane to topple. 8. Be aware of wind conditions and do not operate crane if too windy.	Team Leader Operator	**2**

Nature of Soil (Natural Terrain)	Bearing Capacity
Hard Clay, Requiring jack picking for removal.	**Excellent**
Gravel, coarse sand, in naturally thick beds.	**Excellent**
Loose medium and coarse **sand**, fine compact sand.	**Good**
Medium Clay, stiff but capable of being spaded.	**Medium**
Fine loose sand.	**Fair**
Soft clay.	**Poor**
Loose Fill.	**Do Not Use**

9. Blocks should be used to support the crane outrigger floats when operating on soft ground or where the subsurface is not known.
10. Where blocks are placed under the outrigger beams as back-up protection for the outriggers, sufficient clearance should be maintained between the timber and outrigger beams to ensure that the weight of the crane is supported through the outriggers, not the blocking.

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
	Slewing Cranes could cause damage of plant	**1**	1. Crane set up as per site set up plan and radius and boom length according to safe lifting charts.	Team Leader	**2**
	Rig up counterweights correctly to prevent personnel injury	**1**	1. Only experienced and qualified rigging personnel to rig crane. 2. Preplanning by the crane operator is essential to ensure that the correct personnel are on-site.	Team Leader Management	**2**
Prepare to Undertake Lift	Underrated lifting gear causing rigging gear failure hazards Damage to plant property Death/injury to personnel	**1**	1. Correct lifting gear, sling methods and lift points are to be selected for task by a certified dogman.	Dogman	**2**
	Unknown weight can potentially tip over cranes causing plant/property damage or death/injury to personnel.	**1**	1. Ensure conformance with certified WLL. 2. Cranes will work within their limits at all times as per lift drawings. 3. Operators will not lift beyond WLL of the crane or lifting gear (correct reeving, if undertaken).	Team Leader Operator	**2**
	Height safety hazard when attaching lifting gear may cause death/injury to personnel.	**1**	1. Dogman will assess the risks and implement an appropriate safe method of attaching rigging gear. 2. Scissor lift may be utilised to attach rigging gear to lifting position.	Dogman	**2**
	Overhead and/or under boom obstruction may cause plant damage or injury to persons.	**2**	1. Dogman will assess the risks and radius and implement safe appropriate action. 2. Crane operator will not operate crane if there are overhead and or under boom obstructions.	Dogman Operator	**3**
Undertake Lift	Inadequate communications could cause injury/death to personnel.	**1**	1. Adequate method of communication at all times. 2. Dogman in sight of operator- hand signals. 3. When dogman not in sight of operator use whistles or UHF radios.	Dogman Operator	**2**
	Incorrect radius for task causing crane to topple. Plant/property damage. Death and or injury.	**1**	1. Lift study undertaken. 2. Crane set up at correct radius.	Team Leader Operator	**2**
	Persons under load. Death/Injury.	**1**	1. Crew must not walk under suspended load. 2. All other workgroup personnel are to be made aware of impending lift.	All persons on site.	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
			3. Operator is not to lift load over persons.	Operator	
	Non-certified operators Could cause plant/property damage and death or injury to personnel.	**1**	1. Plant operators are to be high-risk licensed and nominated by management to operate cranes and other high-risk plant.	Management Team Leader Operators	**2**
	Adverse weather conditions ie high wind causing wind to push load out of crane radius and crane toppling. Body parts crushed between load & fixed object.	**1**	1. Crane crew to monitor weather conditions and will stop job if required. 2. Crane will not be operated in adverse weather conditions.	All	**2**
	Crane set up out of placement radius & with less than adequate boom length. Potential crane topple hazard causing injury/death and financial burden.	**1**	1. Crane set up as per site set up plan and radius and boom length according to charts.	Team Leader	**2**
Derig Crane Derig crane counterweights and pack up equipment as required	Personal injury Plant damage	**1**	1. Only experienced and qualified rigging personnel to derig crane. 2. Preplanning by is essential to ensure the same personnel that set up the crane will derig the crane.	Management Team Leader	**2**
Exit Site	Workcrew not signed off and therefore unaccounted for in the event of an emergency.	**2**	1. All crane crew to sign off and/or notify client representative prior to leaving site. 2. Tasks completed and crane plus crew and auxiliary equipment demolished and exited from site.	Team Leader	**3**
General Safety Rules	Potential for personal injury and injuries to other persons.	**1**	1. Do not rush take your time and make sure safety comes first. 2. Always follow the directions of the dogman if a dogman is required. 3. Use the radio remote controls where they are fitted. 4. Never exceed the rated capacity of the machine.	Team Leader Operator Dogmen	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
			5. Operator to test load brakes and machine when a load is first lifted and when the load is only a few inches above its starting position to assure the ability of the brakes to hold the load while it is aloft. 6. The operator should see that; • Loads are well secured before being lifted. • Slings are not kinked. • The load does not catch on obstructions when lifting or swinging. • Sudden stops and starts are avoided. • The hoist line is vertical before starting the lift. • Crane loads, loaded lifting magnets, grapples or buckets do not pass over the heads of workmen nor in any way endanger their safety. • Non-operating personnel should be warned, or told to leave the immediate area when making crane lifts. • No one rides the hook or bucket. 7. Always swing slowly enough to prevent serious outward movement of the load. 8. When performing any sort of crane work ensure the machine is secured against travel and is level. 9. When parking the machine, before leaving the seat of the vehicle set the parking brake, in addition to the air brake. When parking on a grade chock the wheels. 10. When lopping trees the arborist, crane operator and dogger must consult with each other.		
Operating near powerlines	Electrocution	**1**	'No Go Zones' should be adhered to when working near powerlines. Operators need to keep; 1. At least 3 metres from 132,000 volt lines. 2. At least 6 metres from 132,000 to 330,000volt lines. 3. Areas closer than 3m are no go zone. 4. Use certified spotter if working near powerlines. (3m to 6.4m).	Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
			5. Clarify safe working distances with site manager. 6. If in doubt of line voltage keep at least 8 metres away. **If your machine makes contact with electrical wires- Refer to Emergency Procedures below and the A5 laminated card in the cabin.** If any part of the machine contacts a high voltage line, the safest procedure is to stay at your post until contact is cleared or power is shut off. Warn persons on the ground not to touch the crane and to move well clear at least 10m away. If the operator must leave the machine, jump off and do not touch the ground and machine at the same time and hop or shuffle as far away as possible, at least 10m.		
Work Boxes	Potential for personal injury and injuries to other persons.	**1**	1. All persons who are to operate the crane with a workbox attached or are to work from the workbox are to be appropriately trained. 2. Only specifically designed and constructed to AS1418 workboxes are to be used. 3. Crane to be fitted with a positive free-fall lockout control. 4. The crane lifting the work box is to have a minimum WWL of 1000kg at maximum reach. 5. The sides of the work box are to be at least 1m high. 6. Persons in workboxes are to wear safety harnesses. 7. Mobile cranes do not travel while people are in the workbox. 8. Movements of the workbox are to be at slow speed. 9. The workbox is not to be used in high winds or electrical storms. 10. The plant is to be suitably stabilised and always maintained by the operator in that state during which the work box is in use.	Operator	**2**
Traveling	Crane could topple over and injure operator and bystanders.	**1**	1. When traveling the machine, even if it is a short distance, the machine must be in the traveling state (ref to operator's manual for the particular machine you are working with).	Operator	**2**

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards/Risks	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class when Controls In Place
Log Book	Potential for unsafe conditions.	**1**	1. A logbook, bearing the equipment's serial number must be completed and maintained for the duration of the machine life. Records which should be retained in the logbook include the following: • Technical information including maintenance and inspection instructions and performance data provided by the manufacturer. • Details of shock loads, dangerous occurrences and incidents or accidents, however slight. • Test certificates. • Details of ropes including diameter, safe working load, breaking load, length and construction. • All repairs and modifications to the crane, the renewal of major parts and the reason why this operation was necessary. • Schedule and result of maintenance, examination and test.	Operator	**2**
Machine shut down	Unsafe machine	**1**	1. When leaving the control of the machine the following precautions should be observed. • Disengage the engine clutch or shut off the engine to prevent accidental operation of a control. • Lower the crane load to the ground. • Set all drums equipped with manually operated safety pawls on their respective safety pawls. • Set the swing lock and carrier brakes to prevent machine movement. • Never depend on a brake to suspend a load aloft, unless the operator is at the controls, alert, and in a position of readiness to handle the load. As brakes cool off, they may slip, allowing the load to fall to the ground.	Operator	**2**
Maintenance & Repair	Potential for unsafe crane	**1**	1. Preventative maintenance schedules should be adhered to.	Team Leader	**2**

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	**Hazard**	**Risk Class**	**Risk Control Measure**	**Responsible Person/s**	**Risk Class after Controls in place**
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	**1**	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	**2**
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	**2**	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	**3**
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	**2**	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	**3**
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	**2**	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	**3**
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	**1**	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	**2**
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	**1**	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	**2**

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	**2**	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	**3**
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	**1**	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	**2**
Visual Impact **Litter and Amenities** **Waste Management**	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	**2**	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	**3**

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.			
• All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
• If required Client Site Induction • Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	• Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	• Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	• Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
• First Aid certificate training	• Manual Handling training	• Fire Extinguisher training	• Fatigue Management Training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

PANELTEC PTY LTD
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WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.